

Today we begin a new topic. For the next few weeks, we will be investigating
this question:

This is different than all of the questions we've asked so far. It is not a question about how the world is — like the questions about whether God exists, about whether we have free will, and about what we are. Instead, it is a **practical** question — a question about what we ought to do.

This is a kind of question about which most of us have lots of opinions. We all know people who are excessively credulous — they will believe anything.

You may also know people who are excessively skeptical — they refuse to believe things which they should believe. Most of us are probably a blend of these — there are probably domains about which we are too credulous, and domains about which we are too skeptical.

What should I believe?

This is a good time in the class to raise this question. For we've now considered an array of arguments for and against the existence of God, freedom of the will, and your own nature. You may well be asking yourself: what should I now believe about these questions? That is itself a philosophical question, and it will occupy us for the next few weeks.

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